

Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:

Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.

You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double

Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major

If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors

1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit

1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♣

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣5

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥K

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣5

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 5 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 10 7 5
♣ J 9 8

♠ 9

♥ K Q J 7

♦ A K 6

♣ A Q 10 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 7 3

♥ 10 3

♦ Q 9 3 2

♣ 7 3

♠ 10 8 6

♥ A 9 6 4 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K 6 2

SOUTH would have responded 1♥ if EAST had not overcalled. But with only 8 points he cannot bid at the 2-level. The Negative Double solves his problem, giving this information to partner.

NORTH has good ♥s and enough points to bid game. Notice that if EAST had remained silent, SOUTH would have responded 1♥, and NORTH would have jumped to game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

1♠

Dbl

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦3

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 6 2

♥ 9 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ Q 9 8 2

♠ J 5 4

♥ Q 6 5 2

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ A 3



♠ 10 9 7

♥ K 8 7

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 10 4

♠ Q 8 3

♥ A J 10 4

♦ J 5 4

♣ 7 6 5

WEST has four ♠s, so instead of bidding them she makes a Negative Double.

EAST knows there is no 8-card fit in ♠s, but he does have ♥s stopped. He bids 1NT.

WEST has 9 points and with four ♣s she goes back to that suit and EAST passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

1NT

Pass

2 ♣

All Pass

2 ♣ by East

Lead: ♣5

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 4
♥ A K 10 6
♦ J 4 3
♣ A 7 6

♠ Q 9 7
♥ J 8 7
♦ A K 6
♣ K J 10 4



♠ 10 5
♥ Q 5 4 2
♦ Q 10 8 5
♣ 8 5 3

♠ A K 6 3 2
♥ 9 3
♦ 9 7 2
♣ Q 9 2

Compare this hand with Deal 6. SOUTH has five ♠s, this time so she bids 1 ♠.

NORTH knows there IS an 8-card fit in ♠s, so he bids 2 ♠.

SOUTH has 10 points so she passes.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥K			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 5 2
 ♥ A Q 10 9 3
 ♦ 9 7
 ♣ A J 2

♠ Q 10 4 3

♥ J 2

♦ A J 5 4

♣ Q 6 5



♠ 9 7

♥ K 8 7 4

♦ K Q 6

♣ K 10 9 4

♠ K J 8 6

♥ 6 5

♦ 10 8 3 2

♣ 8 7 3

EAST has 11/12 points, a Limit Raise in ♥s. So after the overcall he makes a Support Cue-bid of 2♠.

WEST adds her 16 to the 11 that EAST has promised as a minimum and goes straight to 4♥.

If EAST had significantly more than 11 he could bid on, but in this case he should happily pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

1♠

2♠

Pass

4♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♣5